Key Messages

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- Total losses and partial damages to *Primera* season crops are affecting the region, particularly poor populations in areas within the "Dry Corridor."
- Poor households dependent on subsistence farming activities and households dependent on local day labor are without food reserves at a time of year marked by limited employment opportunities, shortages of seasonal wild foods, and seasonal rises in staple prices.
- Anomalies in the spatial and temporal distribution of rainfall extended into the second half of August, affecting the planting of *Postrera* crops across the region, adding to the damage to populations affected by losses of *Primera* crops, and extending the geographic reach of the damage. This will create shortfalls in national maize and bean production in countries of the region.

COUNTRY	CURRENT ANOMALIES	PROJECTED ANOMALIES
REGIONAL	There is damage to over 60 percent of the area planted in *Primera* crops by subsistence farmers across the region. Losses in El Salvador are assessed at 64 and 82 percent of the area planted in maize and beans, respectively. Losses of maize and bean crops in Honduras' Southern Region as of August are estimated at 94 and 97 percent, respectively. Organizations active in Nicaragua are reporting losses of over 75 percent in certain departments in that country. Rainfall anomalies extending into the second half of August are delaying the planting of *Postrera* crops. Prices for maize and beans are up from last month, marking the seasonal rise in prices.	Larger geographic area affected by losses of *Primera* crops and higher percentage of losses in affected areas across the region. A delay in the resumption of rainfall activity in early September could affect areas already planted in *Postrera* crops and prevent the planting of *Postrera* crops in other areas. Maize and bean price

increases in September will tend to put them above figures for last year due to the losses of *Primera* crops and speculation driven by the likely damage to *Postrera* crops.

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Progess of the Primera growing season

Cumulative rainfall totals for the period from July 26th through August 24th in most parts of Honduras, El Salvador, and Nicaragua were between 25 and 50 percent of the average for that period, with cumulative rainfall levels in certain areas at only five to 25 percent of the average **(Figure 3)**. These rainfall anomalies affected crops in the flowering and grain filling stages. According to estimates of production losses, this has expanded the scope of affected areas to include previously unaffected areas. According to the forecast for El Niño (ENSO) conditions by the International Research Institute for Climate and Society (IRI) as of the middle of August, there willl definitely be El Niño conditions through the end of the year, which suggests there will be damage to *Postrera* crops, worsening food insecurity for the region's poorest populations.

The rainfall anomalies between May and August (including a late start and interruption of the rainy season, and an earlier than usual and protracted *canícula*) caused losses of *Primera* crops at different times, in different stages of development, and in different geographic areas of the three countries. Areas within the "Dry Corridor" were the most affected, but were not the only areas affected. *Postrera* sowing begins in the second half of August, and the outlook for this season is poor due to the overlap with *Primera* crops that were delayed, low rainfall totals, and high temperatures, which could hinder or damage crops across the region.

In **El Salvador,** there was a strong to severe drought in the eastern zone and the coastal area of its para-central zone lasting 20 consecutive days (from July 20th to August 8th). There was a weak to moderate drought in the rest of the country, including five to 15 consecutive days without rain. The rainfall anomalies between May and August affected staple crops for the *Primera*